

BRIAN: Where are we going? Are you —
 PETE: All over America, people are rising up, coming together, speaking as a community on this.
 BRIAN: Yeah, but —
 PETE: Uniting on this one issue as they have not united, as a people, behind anything else. Come on, you got to write this down. I'm doing all the work here. America finding its voice, its identity with a clarity and a strength and a conviction that is drawn from the central core of democracy itself: the will of the people.
 BRIAN: Pete, listen to me. You're, you're you're talking about about about camps, you know, putting people into — camps —
 PETE: Whoa whoa whoa — who said —
 BRIAN: You said —
 PETE: I said, "specialized housing" —
 BRIAN: Yeah, OK, a ghetto, then —
 PETE: This isn't 1939, and it's not Poland, either, and your attitude is, I am not kidding —
 BRIAN: You said —
 PETE: Call it what it is!
 BRIAN: Calling it what it is, is what I am trying to —
 PETE: (*Overlap.*) A working retreat. No, that's —
 BRIAN: (*Overlap, heated.*) You said, hypothetically —
 PETE: (*Snapping.*) Look, what is your problem?
 BRIAN: My problem — my problem is — that even hypothetically, this is wrong!
 PETE: These people have created a very dangerous situation! And it is our job to address that, not to make — excuses —
 BRIAN: I'm not —
 PETE: — For they way they deliberately undermine the legal system and — frankly — defy justice.
 BRIAN: They —
 PETE: They defy it.
 BRIAN: The rights of —
 PETE: Everybody has rights! What about the rights of those Americans who don't want —
 BRIAN: Who don't want other people to have rights?
 PETE: Seventy percent of those polled, the numbers don't lie. Finally, we can stand up and say, this is not what we are. We know what we are, and we are not you.

BRIAN: Yeah, see but —
 PETE: The natural law of the land, a man and a woman —
 BRIAN: Yeah, but there's the problem, see —
 PETE: This is a democracy. The will of the few doesn't get to decide. And they overreached. They want their voices, their few voices, to drown out the will of the majority. And democracy doesn't work that way. Democracy has a higher purpose than self-interest and social fads. Everybody gets a vote, even if it doesn't count. And they are not allowed to fuck with that. The voices of the few do not get to take over and tell the rest of us what goes. It's not going to happen. It's just not. So you can walk away, or you can get on board with this, now.
 (*Beat.*)
 BRIAN: So . . . run it by me again, how do we get from —
 PETE: Overreaching, undermining democracy —
 BRIAN: Yeah, OK, to, uh "specialized housing"?
 PETE: All the demonstrating for their so-called rights. They're demonstrating, right? They violate the law, they go to jail. You put enough of them in jail, and then you segregate them for their own good.
 BRIAN: Oh.
 PETE: They segregate themselves anyway, they take over neighborhoods and redecorate, all over America, that's what they do. So once you've done that —
 BRIAN: (*With sorrowful irony.*) Sure, it's a hop and a skip.
 PETE: People want this. I mean, a lot of people, *The New York Times*, will get all whiney about it when it first shows up, but trust me, America wants this. And let me promise you, the powers that be, the boys who sign our checks? They really want it. So stop acting like the world just ended, this is a good idea and you know it. I just saved both our butts.
 BRIAN: And we're not talking hypothetical?
 PETE: I don't think we have to be. I really don't. (*Beat.*) Write it down!
 (*Cheerful, he taps the page. Blackout.*)

END OF PLAY